Jahangir went overboard in penalizing anyone who disagreed with him. During his reign, many prominent Muslims had disagreements with him, after which they couldn't escape his wrath however important they were to society. The noteworthy Sufi Sheikh Ahmad Sirhindi once pronounced that 'he once came closer to Allah than the Caliphs in his dreams'. This made Jahangir furious as he saw this as an insult to the Caliphs. Yet another Sufi named Sheikh Nizam Thanesari was expatriated to Mecca on the charge of accompanying Khusrau Mirza for some distance.[*] Jahangir had this trend of rewarding people after testing their knowledge and realizing their economic condition every day. But he ensured that his patronage and support went especially to the Muslims.[†]

Shah Jahan, son of Jahangir, was way ahead of his father in terms of barbarity. It was merely in the first decade (sixth year) of his regnum year that he passed a farman to raze mandirs, whose foundations had been laid during his father's period and stood unfinished. He was high with the zeal to revive Islam in the best possible way. He intended to reflect Islam as a dominant religion, and hence apart from demolishing mandirs, he commissioned many grand mosques like the Jama Masjid in Delhi.[‡]

Well, even the Taj has enough baggage of a gory past. There is a school of thought that claims it to be a mandir in reality. I'm not going to address the *truth* of this matter (based on primary sources) here. It will be addressed in the volume which will exclusively talk about Shah Jahan. Here, I would briefly touch on a part of the issue, which when revealed, had shocked me enormously. It is recorded that when the Taj Mahal was built (AD 1631), it cost around 41.8 million silver rupees.[§] To set things in perspective, I am providing some mathematics for the readers. On average, the mean income of a farmer's family was 'one *Dam* (copper coin) per day'. One silver rupee was equivalent to forty *Dams*,[¶] and a single rupee would get you around 280 kilograms of general-grade rice during Shah Jahan's reign. Now, the question arises as to why this analysis was important and how it brought more shocks in my NCERT-history-educated life.

This was the time when the great Deccan Famine (AD 1630–31 AD) had occurred, and around 7.4 million[**] had succumbed to the same. It may sound strange, but this famine was created by the Tīmūrid Prince Shah Jahan himself. In AD 1631, the army under Shah Jahan marched to Malwa as one of his commanders stationed there had rebelled and joined hands with *Adilshahis* of Bijapur and *Nizamshahis* of Hyderabad. The army intended to teach the rebel commander a lesson. The records state that Tīmūrids (distorted as Moghūls)